

Chapter 20

When Yin Lingzhu counted to twenty sheep again, feeling the warmth from the person beside her, she felt utterly helpless.

Had Yan Si always had this habit?

Unfortunately, she still didn't know the answer to this question.

Usually, even when she could share a bed with Yan Si, it was only when marking her.

Each temporary marking was an extremely exhausting process for Yin Lingzhu.

The next day, her body would feel very weak, her limbs soft and powerless.

She had asked You Xiaoxiao about it, who told her it was due to defects from her secondary differentiation¹.

Usually, after she marked Yan Si, the rapid loss of pheromones would make her fall into a deep sleep. When she woke up the next day, there was usually no one beside her.

Come to think of it, she had never once seen Yan Si sleeping.

Yin Lingzhu turned her head to look at Yan Si. Sure enough, Yan Si's head was almost on her pillow.

If Yin Lingzhu hadn't tucked her blanket so tightly, Yan Si would probably have already burrowed into her covers.

Yin Lingzhu reached out and shook Yan Si, "Wake up, you've moved to my side again."

Having been disturbed repeatedly, Yan Si grabbed Yin Lingzhu's wrist that had just pushed her and pulled hard.

Yin Lingzhu wasn't prepared for this and found herself propping herself up above Yan Si.

It looked like a kabedon².

"We're sleeping, don't make trouble, okay?" Yan Si didn't even open her eyes, her voice soft.

Seeing Yan Si like this, Yin Lingzhu had no choice but to pull her wrist from Yan Si's hand, sigh, and burrow back into her own blanket.

She didn't want to think about whether she would forgive Yan Si if they entangled like this every day.

The next day.

The seven o'clock alarm rang on time.

Hearing the sound, Yin Lingzhu quickly tapped the screen to turn it off, then looked toward Yan Si with a guilty conscience.

Seeing that Yan Si hadn't been woken up, she breathed a sigh of relief.

What was this about? It wasn't like she had done anything wrong to Yan Si.

Yin Lingzhu noticed her own behavior and stiffened for a moment, very confused, but her movements of getting up, washing, and leaving were all careful and cautious.

What Yin Lingzhu didn't know was that the moment she woke up, Yan Si had also awakened.

Yan Si deliberately pretended to sleep. She wanted to know what Yin Lingzhu's reaction would be if she got up first.

She couldn't say what kind of result she wanted either.

Last night, Yan Si actually hadn't slept as well as she had thought.

The second time Yin Lingzhu pushed her, she had already woken up, but she deliberately pretended not to wake up—she just wanted to get a little closer to Yin Lingzhu.

Yan Si didn't get up directly, but instead rolled to where Yin Lingzhu had been sleeping. There was no warmth left.

Even though it was summer now, without a person's presence, warmth dissipated quickly.

After lying there for a while, Yan Si got up. Looking at the two sets of bedding on the bed, she felt indescribable emotions.

After Yin Lingzhu left in the morning, she removed Yan Si's various contact methods from her blacklist.

She had been too impulsive at the time—there was no need to block Yan Si.

After all, she and Yan Si hadn't gotten their divorce certificate yet, so she still needed to contact Yan Si.

Yin Lingzhu rested for the entire day. That night at the hotel, she didn't sleep peacefully—she dreamed of her previous world.

The period before she transmigrated hadn't been pleasant.

From childhood to adulthood, Yin Lingzhu had always been the "other people's child³" that relatives and friends talked about.

She was good-looking, excellent in her studies, studied the popular major of computer science in university, got a job at a big tech company⁴, and earned over ten thousand yuan per month.

Her parents doted on her immensely, almost with spoiling education. It was a miracle that Yin Lingzhu's personality hadn't gone astray.

Yin Lingzhu lived in an atmosphere full of love, so she had enough love to give to others.

Many people surrounded Yin Lingzhu—no one didn't want to be with someone full of positive energy.

But Yin Lingzhu only considered a few people as friends in her heart. For her, the others were just classmates and colleagues.

During her adolescence, Yin Lingzhu had no one who made her heart flutter, but that didn't mean others weren't attracted to her.

She would receive many love letters, from both boys and girls, but without exception, she rejected them all.

She hadn't met someone she liked; she couldn't experience that kind of "love."

Watching the couples around her, she had thought about whether she should just randomly choose one of her suitors to date, but in the end, she gave up on this choice.

She didn't want to have contact with someone she didn't like.

Days passed by peacefully like this.

After she started working, her parents were in a car accident during one of their outings.

Yin Lingzhu waited outside the hospital room all night, only to receive the doctor's "I'm sorry."

Looking at her parents covered with white sheets, a sense of powerlessness surged in her heart.

Finally, she scattered her parents' ashes into the sea.

She had always been her parents' pride, but there was one thing she hadn't done well.

Watching her parents' interactions, she could feel there was a kind of magnetic field between them. Yin Lingzhu knew that was love.

But she had never experienced it.

Since she entered university, every New Year, relatives would always ask her if she had a boyfriend and when she would get married.

Her parents would help her deflect, awkwardly laughing and saying she was still young and there was no rush.

But she knew her parents would also discuss her marriage prospects behind her back.

From childhood to adulthood, her parents had never expected anything from her—even regarding grades, they had no requirements.

So Yin Lingzhu couldn't understand why her parents were so persistent about her marriage.

When she was a sophomore in university, her parents started urging her to bring home a boyfriend, and they kept urging until she had been working for two years after graduation.

Each year they became more anxious, each year their tone became more urgent. Her parents had been urging her for five years.

That thought emerged again.

She thought, maybe she should just randomly find someone to be her marriage partner.

From childhood to adulthood, she had rarely made her parents worry, and she didn't want to trouble them with this matter either.

This thought was just a fleeting one. Like her youthful answer, she didn't want to have contact with someone she didn't like.

Being with someone she liked had become her obsession, her inner demon.

Yin Lingzhu looked at the endless sea, recalling her entire life. In a trance, she fell into the water.

Her breath was quickly submerged by seawater. The instinct for survival made her arms move, trying to make herself surface.

But her strength was quickly exhausted in the water, and her arms dropped powerlessly.

When she opened her eyes again, she had transmigrated here.

Meeting Yan Si, she finally understood—she was normal, she had the ability to like someone.

Yan Si had resolved her obsession.

In her sleep, Yin Lingzhu opened her eyes, her heart beating very fast.

There was a small night light in the room that stayed on.

The light was tiny in the night but gave hope.

Yin Lingzhu's gaze turned to the lamp, her eyes flickering, unable to tell what she was thinking.

She looked at her phone—Tuesday, 6:20.

There was still quite a while before her seven o'clock alarm.

With no sleepiness left, she simply found a dance tutorial and started practicing.

Until Saturday, Yin Lingzhu practiced dancing at the studio during the day and rested at the hotel at night. Yan Si didn't look for her during this time.

The variety show Yang Daiyi had signed them up for would start filming next Monday.

On Friday night, Yin Lingzhu sent Yan Si a text message saying they would go get the divorce certificate tomorrow morning.

Yan Si's response could be called instant, but her message wasn't an agreement.

【I agreed to go to the civil affairs bureau with you, but I didn't say we'd get a divorce certificate.】

Yin Lingzhu hadn't expected this to be Yan Si's answer. She carefully recalled—Yan Si indeed hadn't said they would get the certificate.

She gritted her teeth. Yan Si loved playing word games this much?

【How can you be so shameless】

Yin Lingzhu's fingers pressed against the screen with clicking sounds, showing how much force she was using.

【It's not shameless, it's clever.】

Yan Si's message came quickly—it looked like she had been specifically waiting for her.

Footnotes:

¹ **Secondary differentiation:** In the ABO (Alpha/Beta/Omega) universe setting, this refers to when someone undergoes a second biological change in their designation, often causing physical complications or instabilities.

² **Kabedon (壁ドン):** A Japanese term that has become popular in Chinese internet culture, referring to the romantic gesture of slamming one's hand against a wall to pin someone, often seen in romance manga and dramas.

³ **"Other people's child" (别人家的孩子):** A common Chinese expression referring to an exemplary child that parents use as a comparison when criticizing their own children—essentially "that perfect kid your parents always compare you to."

⁴ **Big tech company (大厂):** Chinese slang for major technology companies like Alibaba, Tencent, Baidu, etc., which are highly coveted employers offering good salaries and benefits.